Appendix: Search strategies

MEDLINE

(randomized controlled trial[pt] OR controlled clinical trial[pt] OR randomized[tiab] OR placebo[tiab] OR drug therapy[sh] OR randomly[tiab] OR trial[tiab] OR groups[tiab] NOT (animals [mh] NOT humans [mh])

AND

(patellar tendon[Title/Abstract]) OR hamstring tendon[Title/Abstract]) OR Autograft[Title/Abstract]) OR autografts[Title/Abstract]) OR semitendinosus[Title/Abstract]) OR bone patellar tendon bone grafts[MeSH Terms] OR Tendons[MeSH Terms] OR bone patellar tendon bone graft*[Title/Abstract])

AND

(ACL reconstruction[Title/Abstract]) OR ACL rupture[Title/Abstract]) OR ACL arthroscopic[Title/Abstract]) OR Anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction[Title/Abstract]) OR Anterior cruciate ligament rupture[Title/Abstract]) OR ACL surgery[Title/Abstract]) OR Anterior cruciate ligament surgery[Title/Abstract]) OR anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction[MeSH Terms]) OR acl ruptures[Title/Abstract]) OR acl reconstructions[Title/Abstract])))) OR ACL repair[Title/Abstract] OR anterior cruciate ligament injuries [MeSH Terms] OR ACL tear [Title/Abstract] OR anterior cruciate ligament tear [Title/Abstract])

EMBASE

'anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction':ab,ti OR 'acl repair':ab,ti OR 'acl rupture':ab,ti OR 'acl reconstruction':ab,ti OR 'acl surgery':ab,ti OR 'anterior cruciate ligament surgery':ab,ti OR 'anterior cruciate ligament repair':ab,ti)

AND

'patellar ligament':ab,ti OR 'hamstring tendon':ab,ti OR 'semitendinous muscle':ab,ti OR 'bone patellar tendon bone graft':ab,ti)

AND

[randomized controlled trial]/lim

CENTRAL

ID Search Hits

#2 (acl reconstruction):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#3 (acl rupture):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#4 (acl arthroscopic):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#5 (anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#6 (anterior cruciate ligament rupture):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#7 (acl surgery):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#8 (anterior cruciate ligament surgery):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#9 MeSH descriptor: [Anterior Cruciate Ligament Reconstruction] explode all trees

#10 MeSH descriptor: [Anterior Cruciate Ligament Injuries] explode all trees

#11

#12 (patellar tendon):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#13 (hamstring tendon):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#14 (autograft):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#15 ("semitendinosus tendon"):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched) in Trials

#16 MeSH descriptor: [Bone-Patellar Tendon-Bone Grafting] explode all trees

#17 MeSH descriptor: [Hamstring Tendons] explode all trees

#18

WEB OF SCIENCE

1. TS=(ACL reconstruction* OR ACL rupture* OR ACL arthroscopic* OR anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction OR anterior cruciate ligament rupture OR ACL surgery OR anterior cruciate ligament surgery OR ALCR OR ACL repair OR anterior cruciate ligament repair)

2. TS=(patellar tendon OR hamstring tendon OR BPTB OR HT OR autograft* OR semitendinosus OR bone patellar tendon bone graft OR four strand OR quadriceps tendon)

3. TS=("clinical trial" OR "randomization" OR "crossover procedure" OR "placebo" OR "prospective study" OR (randomi$ed NEAR/1 "controlled trial") OR "rct" OR (allocat* NEAR/2 random*) OR ((single OR double OR treble OR triple) NEAR/1 blind*))